The platypus – bird, mammal or reptile?

☞ **1** Use the word bank to label the picture below.



Word bank

fur
claws
flat tail
duck-like bill

The platypus is a unique kind of mammal called a **monotreme**. Echidnas are the only other kind of monotreme. When scientists in Europe first saw the hide of a dead platypus they thought it was a joke. They had never seen anything like it before, and assumed it was a made-up animal sewn together from parts of other animals.

☞ **2** Match the following statements to describe the platypus.

The platypus has a bill	a poisonous spur on its back leg.
The male has	tail like a beaver.
The female platypus	claws like an otter.
It has a flat	temperature of about 32°C.
The young lick milk	like a duck.
They have	lays eggs.
The platypus has a low core	from their mother's belly fur.

3 How is a platypus like a reptile? _____

_____

4 How is a platypus like a bird? _____

_____

5 How is a platypus like a mammal? _____

_____

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